University of Colorado at Boulder

ARTS 1212-285R PAINTING FOR NON-MAJORS
3 Credit Spring 2024
Gen Ed Distribution: Arts and Humanities
Tyler Alpern, MFA Creative Minds Residential Academic Program at Libby

Place and Time:

* Libby Basement Studio on Mondays and Wednesdays at 1:00pm - 3:30pm. In-Person. Zoom is not an option.
*Office Hours: Mondays & Wednesdays 4:50pm by appointment
*Check "Canvas" for class and grade info, handouts and important links for demos or examples and assignment help.
*Check CU email daily for important messages, opportunities and occasional class bulletins.

Contacts:

Tyler Alpern (he, him, his) Email: Tyler.alpern@colorado.edu Web: Canvas.

Important Dates:

Class dates: 1/17 - 5/1
Mandatory Final Exam Period: Celebration of the Arts 5/1 6pm.

Course Description:

Explores varied painting techniques. Introduces concepts relevant to the understanding of painting and the creative process.

Learning Objectives:

This course is a basic introduction to the field of painting in contemporary art studio practice. Students will gain valuable academic and life skills through exposure to the creative process, design thinking and idea production, risk taking and coping with frustration and failure. Students will be encouraged to take risks and challenge themselves to make better paintings. Because of this experimentation and risk taking occasional awful looking work is inevitable and expected. Just as a musician practices his or her craft for countless hours; to learn to paint, one must make paintings, heaps of them to become good. Students may make some really bad paintings. That is expected as part of the learning process. Learning to cope with and work through frustration is essential. As long as the painting demonstrates the requirements of the assignment, students will be earning credit, even for a bad painting.

Observation will be combined with subjective technical considerations to best create the illusion of three dimensional reality on a flat two dimensional surface. Students thus learn how to paint what they intend the viewer to perceive, not simply what the artist sees. Working too closely from photographs inhibits this process. Students will also create a paintings don't imitate the world as it appears, but express their own imaginations and investigate formal and graphic and surface ideas so that they understand other functions and possibilities of painting. There are additional learning objectives for this class as part of the First Year Experience.

Course Projects:

Students will start to develop and experiment with their own styles and content while learning and practicing technical skills and color theory. Assignments will explore: Elements of Color, Color Mixing, Transparency vs. Opacity, Depth, Light Strategies, Atmospheric Perspective, Layering, Color Perception, Social Art, Emphasis, Design Thinking and Idea Production, Composition, Style, Appropriation, the Creative Process, the Value of Art and Art Education. We will look at paintings from many different eras, cultures, ethnic and social groups.

Spending time drawing, brain storming and planning is fundamental practice for a developing artist. **Daily drawing is a mandatory habit or practice required for the class.** Create and date a 5+ minute drawing outside of class 5 days a week in your sketchbook. Each drawing is required to have at least 2 elements and a background intended to develop ideas for paintings. You will have to complete projects in class based on your own ideas that you formulate outside of class in your sketchbook. During the first 4 weeks of class, you'll collecting a minimum of 20 painted images that inspire you from at least 15 different artists in order to hone your aesthetic and find which kinds of paintings you'd like to create.

Performance and Grading Policy:

COURSE TOTAL = 100 POINTS. Grading scale: 99-90 = A, 89-80 = B, 79-70 = C, 69-60 = D, below 60 = F
Sketchbook 7pts., Coursework 69pts., 2 RAP/UNIV Events 4 pts., Attendance and Participation 20 pts.

Extra Credit: You can earn up to 3 points extra credit OR make up a missed class by attending extra approved RAP events or other special CU events (with Tyler's permission.) There are many engaging additional exercises on Canvas in the Modules section that can be completed for extra credit or absence make ups.

Your final grade for the course includes attendance. This is tabulated by subtracting absence penalties from your overall 20 point count in the Participation and Attendance category on Canvas. Course content is delivered in person so attendance of all classes is mandatory. Pay careful attention to the attendance policies and manage effectively any absence:

Manage effectively any absence by paying attention to the following:
* Contact me via Canvas or email ASAP for each absence to stay informed, caught up, and to plan for a make up.
* **Absences do not excuse responsibility for the class missed**. In this class, the policy for religious holidays is the same for any missed class with opportunity to make up for lost points. Each of the first 3 absences are an automatic 3 point deduction in your Participation Grade. The 4th or more absences, will lower your grade 5 points. However 6 or more cumulative absences, even made up, may result in course failure. Additional points may be deducted from the final project if your participation grade hits zero. In cases of hospitalization or a death in the family, or prolonged absences contact your instructor immediately to discuss options. Stay in communication if missing more than 2 classes in a row. Perfect attendance earns **Extra Credit**.
* Each tardy, early departure, or excessive break, counts as a loss of 1 or more points. Missing more than 15 minutes of a period also counts as a tardy. A bad attitude on a day when we try something you do not like or not following assignment directions, not using good studio practices, failure to clean up your space, or texting during a lecture will count as an absence or a tardy.
Presentations are given at the start of each class so please BE ON TIME - even one minute late after presentations begin may be considered tardy. "Those who are tardy will not receive fruit cup."

Please continue coming to class even if you are unprepared, are missing a due date or falling behind. I understand how this sometimes happens and being in class is essential for the learning process and for me to help you one on one with your work or any obstacles and frustrations you are facing. Engage in email contact during your absence.

Your grade for each assignment is based on effort, attitude and attendance, not ability. 2 points deducted for late work each period past due. I want you to take risks and not worry about beauty, success, or artistic ability of finished work, grades are only based on fulfilling assignment instructions and requirements. Assignments must be completed and approved to get full credit.

Grading scale for art projects
A) full engagement in the process;
B) use of the set parameters and suggestions an interesting work that does not quite fulfill the requirements adequately;
C) a mixture of strengths and weaknesses, partially fulfills assignment;
D) poor in content, form, and mechanics;
F) does not follow assignment incoherent, disastrously flawed, or not turned in
Missing a lecture or demo for a particular project lowers the grade for that assignment one grade level.

Miscellaneous:

*USE RESPECT: for yourself, your classmates, the room and materials in it. Realize that a portion of your grade is your conduct in the studio. That includes safety issues, respect for the work of others and cleaning up after yourself. **Clean and wipe down your space after every class!**

*Use of headphones allowed only if completely inaudible to others and may be disallowed.

*The instructor reserves right to modify syllabus and calendar for the class.

*Text messaging allowed only at discretion of instructor. **Never during lecture or in front of guests - you'll be given an automatic tardy.** Cell privileges may be revoked.

**Communication is the key to success in this class. If there is anything of concern, see me, call or e-mail.* Emailing your instructor when you are absent can help mitigate absence consequences and reduce grade penalties. It is NOT an appropriate solution to complain to an advisor or other university staff or administrator about an aspect of this class without discussing it with me first. See RAP Director Cecilia Pang if we can not resolve an issue ourselves.

*Class is likely cancelled due to any active fires in the Lefthand Canyon Area.

*It is the responsibility of all faculty and staff to report any sexual misconduct to a Title IX Officer, whether or not the student prefer for the information to remain confidential.

* "In an instructional setting, **plagiarism** occurs when a writer (or artist) deliberately uses someone else's language, ideas, or other original (not common-knowledge) material without acknowledging its source." It is the student's responsibility to understand and avoid plagiarism. **Visual work should also be original and any source or inspirational material must be shown to the instructor to avoid plagiarism and a potential honor code violation and academic sanctions ranging from minus 2 times the assignment's points to course failure.**
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*Everyone makes mistakes reading out loud, mispronouncing words, stammering, etc. If you have a disability such as dyslexia and prefer that you are not overly challenged or taxed reading complex matter in front of the class, please let me know.

*Someone else receiving extra credit does not hurt your grade and has nothing to do with your work or attendance.

*Please let me know if you are unhappy with your creative work. I allow you space to work and figure out solutions on your own without too much interference. But do speak up if you are frustrated, could use some help, or simply don't like how your painting is turning out, especially as the painting nears completion.

***Class Format:**
Before EVERY Class: check CU email and Canvas announcements for daily instructions.
1:00 pm In class. Attendance taken. **3:10 pm:** Clean up space by washing table and neatly stacking easel.

Required Materials:

You can choose to paint in either oil or acrylic paint. Both are wonderful and versatile. Similar effects can be made with either but one is often better choice than the other for various effects. Oil paint is thinned with oil or a solvent. Acrylic can be thinned with water or a medium. Oil paint takes days to months to dry while acrylic can dry in minutes. If you like to blend paint or have sharp surface texture, or paint slowly oil may be a better choice. If you like to make radical changes, have flat opaque color, do collage or are sensitive to chemicals, acrylic may be a better choice. Acrylic colors can be less transparent and may dry slightly darker. Acrylic comes in more unusual, gimmicky colors but oil paints can be easier to mix to find the right color. Acrylics mediums are used for image transfers and collages and can be used by both acrylic and oil painters. Oil goes over acrylic so you can use acrylic products and techniques under an oil painting. You choose. Supply kits available through the CU Bookstore and distributed at Libby. See me if cost is prohibitive.

Canvas Paper Pad, minimum of 10 brushes that are not too soft (#1, #4 or #6 round and flat, #12 flat) - the more the better. , Sketchbook.

PAINT: large tube of white (zinc or titanium), thalo (phthalocyanine) blue, ultramarine blue, thalo red rose (or another rose or magenta - not too pink or purple - acra, quinarcidone in acrylic), cadmium red hue (that looks red not orange), burnt umber, cadmium yellow medium hue, zinc or lemon yellow.

OIL PAINTERS: 1 plastic squeeze bottle, Gamsol.

The RAP will provide: palette paper (oil) or stay wet palette (acrylic) and 18 x 24 canvases.

General supplies: scissors, rubber cement, paper towels should be available in the studio.

CU Policies:

* Required CU Syllabus Statements covering Covid, Classroom Behavior, Honor Code, Religions Holidays, Accommodations, Sexual Misconduct/Harassment/Discrimination are posted online for our class on Canvas and on the CU Website.

In this class the policy for religious holidays is that make up work must be submitted class 27 to fully excuse the absence without penalty.

In this class, if you are sick or quarantined, notify by Tyler by email before each class period. All absences will be needed to be made up with one of the extra credit or make up options provided on Canvas or an approved CU Event within 2 weeks or by Class 27 whichever comes first.

Additional Statements:

Statement of Inclusivity

The instructor and class members in this course strive to support an inclusive learning community, respecting those of all backgrounds and beliefs. As a community, we aim to be respectful to all people regardless of race, ethnicity, religion, age, ability, immigration or economic status, gender or sexual orientation.

Respect and Honesty in Dialogue
We all come from different perspectives on these issues. It is likely (even inevitable) that we will disagree with each other. We welcome and encourage lively dialogue, as it is necessary for true learning to occur. **However, disagreements should never take the form of personal attack.** Mutual respect is required in order to maximize a healthy and fair learning environment. In addition, the nature of this course involves challenging ourselves to be honest in expressing our thoughts and feelings. We will come to a deeper understanding of this as a group as we create a set of guidelines together to structure our dialogue early in the semester.

Additional Learning Outcomes For Painting and Drawing in CM RAP
By offering a flex learning system to all, students to craft personal strategies and pathways to success, eliminating stress and strengthening their physical and mental wellness. In addition the RAP provides wellness seminars.

By requiring participation in some RAP and Campus Events and Seminars students have opportunity to discover and take advantage of a myriad of opportunities and services offered at CU Boulder.

By including, deconstructing and discussing the artwork and images of artists of many different races and backgrounds and though RAP DEI events, this course will convey the value of diversity in learning and community and provide opportunities to explore identity. Students will be exposed to diverse points of view, experiences, and cultures.

By participating in class, collaborating on group projects, exhibiting artwork at the Celebration of the Arts with fellow residents of Libby Hall and learning everyone's name, students will develop a sense of belonging and affinity with CU. They will know people know who they are and have a forum to express their thoughts, feelings and beliefs through sharing artwork and ideas and interpersonal and team-work skills in the process.

By using the process of design thinking students for nearly every project will learn how to achieve excellent in idea development which fosters intellectual curiosity. Deconstructing images in class helps to refined critical thinking skills.

By engaging in the experiential learning of art making students will gain an appreciation for ways of knowing that go beyond verbal expression.

By experimenting, taking risks and learning from inevitable failures that they encounter as part of the the creative process, students will gain problem-solving skills and become more adaptable, courageous, and be able to cope with frustration.

Schedule - Subject to Change:

Turn in work digitally via Canvas. Visit http://www.tyleralpern.com/paint1.html for assignment details, demos and tips. Link also found on Canvas. See important assignment info following the schedule below.

Class 1: Introductions & Community - Remote.

Homework: 1) Obtain drawing materials for next class or purchase them in class. **2)** Read the 3 short articles about creativity gathered together in the Creativity PDF on Canvas and follow instructions at the end by Class 4. *3*) Answer Syllabus Questions by Class 4 **4)** Find and collect 5+ inspirational paintings per week for the first 4 weeks. *A few commonly known, popular artists you may not use are: Leonid Afremov, Thomas Kinkade, Bob Ross, Vladimir Kush, Josephine Wall. I need you to do research that goes beyond the first few pages of a general google painting search. Try* http://www.thisiscolossal.com *and other art blogs listed on Canvas. Then assemble your 20 favorites in a PDF document by Class 13.*

Class 2 - 5: Idea Production, Color Theory, Visual Literacy Due by Class 8. **7pts.**
Purpose: To learn how to see value, temperature and saturation in color, to understand color theory, to explore visual language and develop ideas for self expression. Idea Planning Exercises explore: Repetition, Space, Contrast, Scale. Lectures: Introduction to Color, Creating Dynamic Compositions, How to Look for and at Paintings for Inspiration, Effective Sketch booking, Creativity, Design Thinking, Principles of Design and Visual Mechanics.

Homework reminder: Remember you are to draw every single day in your sketchbook and date the drawings. Each drawing must have 2 or more elements and background. But the goal is to brainstorm and develop ideas for paintings, and to create a regular drawing and thinking habit that provides discipline and prevents "artist block" from happening due to frustration, perfectionism, or lack of inspiration.

Early in the term, you are to collect 20 images of paintings that inspire you because of how they are painted (unusual color choices, bold brushstrokes, lost edges, creative interpretations) not what they are paintings of. Remember the list of artists not to choose that is in your syllabus! Place your choices in a PDF with a few sentences about why you chose them and email to me by Class 13. Then we will have a one on one discussion about them.

Classes 6 - 8: Shading Theory: Tromp L'oeil Due by Class 10**. 8pts.** Purpose: To be able to paint what is real or imagined on a flat surface with the sharp illusion of mass and volume and use color effectively.
Lectures: Language of Light, Simultaneous Contrast.
***Homework:** in your sketchbook present 3 different ideas for your first creative painting by Class 12. Each idea should have 10 different compositional thumbnail sketches. Try different points of view, scale, arrangements, overlap, emphasis, etc. See important assignment info following the schedule.

Classes 9- 10 3-D Object Painting Due by Class 12. **5pts.**
Purpose: To apply skills learned so far in a creative work. Painting must have a strong illusion of 3-D volume, and follow the rules of atmospheric perspective. Do not paint something shiny, reflective, transparent or too complex.
**SKETCHBOOKS DUE Class 9 including 3 Creativity drawings based on readings.*
Class 10: Repetition,Scale,Space Review.

Classes 11 - 12: Value Exercises.
Due by Class 14. **4 Points**: To apply skills learned so far in a creative work.
Class 11: Beyond Local Color Intro, Class 12: Composition variations, Layering Intro.
Due Class 13: 20 Inspirational paintings collected for presentation and discussion. A few commonly known, popular artists you may not use are: Leonid Afremov, Thomas Kinkade, Bob Ross, Vladimir Kush, Josephine Wall. I need you to do research that goes beyond the first few pages of a general google painting search. Assemble 20 images with a sentence or 2 about why you chose that work into a PDF and email to me or submit via Canvas.* **5pts.

Classes 13 - 18: Creative Painting or Series 1 Due by Class 22. **15pts.**
Go **Beyond Local Color t**o learn how value is more important than hue in crafting an image. Use expressive, personal color and **Layering and Transparency to** learn how to craft a painting using an under painting. Begin to find an artistic voice by using **Scale, Repetition or Space** to communicate important ideas.
Lectures: Value, Layering, Color Perception, Deep vs Flat Space, painting tips: flesh tones, eyes, use of grays, skies, water, etc. Class 13 & 14 Detour.

Classes 19-21: Creative Painting or Series 2 Due by the end of Class 21 **10pts**
Flat Color and Text. Purpose: To embrace flat rather than modeled color in an image whether 3-D or flat in appearance, use text as a design element.
Classes 18 &19 Lectures for Painting 2, Classes 20 & 21 Lecture for Painting 3.

Class 22 - 29: Creative Painting or Series 3 Due by Class 28**. 15pts.**
Final Project and Critique.
***Due Class 24** *Sketchbooks* **5 additional pts.**
Contrast & Depth Purpose: to communicate visually by using 2 or more elements not usually associated together and to communicate a sense of space by effectively using mechanics of compositional placement, scale. overlap, atmospheric perspective, detail, and color.

Videos: Behind the Scenes Flat vs. Deep with David Hockney, Color Theory with Robert Gilles De Montes, and assorted other clips.
***Due By Class 27:** Any extra credit, late work or make-ups. Hard deadline. Do not miss.
Class 29: Final Individual Critiques. 6:00 PM, Celebration of the Arts - attendance and participation mandatory.

MANDATORY FINAL: CELEBRATION OF THE ARTS 5/1 6PM

Class Dates: **1:** 1/17, **2:** 1/22, **3:** 1/24 **4:** 1/29, **5:** 1/31, **6:** 2/5, **7:** 2/7, **8:** 2/12, **9:** 2/14, **10:** 2/19, **11:** 2/21, **12:** 2/26, **13:** 2/28, **14:** 3/4 **15:** 3/6, **16:** 3/11, **17:** 3/13, **18:** 3/18, **19:** 3/20, **20:** 4/1, **21:** 4/3, **22:** 4/8, **23:** 4/10, **24:** 4/15, **25:** 4/17, **26:** 4/22, **27:** 4/24, **28:** 4/29, **29:** 5/1. **BREAK:** 3/25 - 3/29.

It is the nature of art that some painters are quicker than others, some artists take on more ambitious projects than others. Simply completing all assignments early does not excuse students from attending classes. Students must work on projects and be present every week. Should a student finish a creative painting assignment early, then they will continue working by producing a series of related works.

MANDATORY FINAL: CELEBRATION OF THE ARTS 4/27 6PM

Important Assignment Info:

* **Every new painting must have at least 10 compositional sketches** completed before image is put on canvas or at a critical decision making point if more applicable than sketching ideas before hand. This helps find the most dynamic presentation of your idea.

* Working from photos as a reference is allowed, but **copying individual photos (even your own) is not allowed.** All paintings must be a significant departure from any photographic work, especially those created by other artists or gleaned from other sources. Parts of photos may be used and copied to create your own new work. Show Tyler every photographic source. No credited will be given to work that closely resembles a singular photographic source.

* **No exact resemblance in portraiture will be allowed** until the final project as struggling to achieve a likeness interferes with the lessons to be learned in assigned work.

* **Missing the fundamental lecture or presentation for painting project can lower the grade for that project by up to 3 points.**

Additional Learning Outcomes For Painting and Drawing in CM RAP

By offering a flex learning system to all, students can craft personal strategies and pathways to success, eliminating stress and strengthening their physical and mental wellness. In addition the RAP provides wellness seminars for which credit is given.

By requiring participation in some RAP and Campus Events and Seminars students have opportunity to discover and take advantage of a myriad of opportunities and services offered at CU Boulder.

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By using the process of design thinking students for nearly every project will learn how to achieve excellence in idea development which fosters intellectual curiosity. Deconstructing images in class helps to refine critical thinking skills and understand non-verbal communication.

By engaging in the experiential learning of art making students will gain an appreciation for the power of alternate ways of knowing and expression that go beyond written language and the spoken word.

Answer all the following by class 3.

1. How many points are deducted from your 100 point final grade for each absence no matter what the reason?

2. How can you make up points for a missed class?

3. What is the point penalty for texting during a lecture or presentation?

4. What happens to your grade if you miss 6 or more classes?

5. When is your "final exam period" for this class?

6. What is considered plagiarism in this class?

7. What are the sketchbook expectations? How many drawings should they contain each week? What should the drawings be like?

8. What are the expectations/protocols of working from photos?

9. What is a RAP and what are some of the benefits of being in a RAP? (See Canvas Announcements for info)

10. How many Creative Minds at Libby RAP/University events are you required to attend?